

THE PERSON IN THE MIRROR

5-MINUTE SHORT FILM SCREENPLAY

Genre: Psychological Drama

Actors: 1

Actor: ARUN

Locations: House + Park

Props: Smartphone, mirror, notebook

CAT-2: First 2 minutes

End Semester: Complete 5 minutes

FADE IN:

0:00–0:30 — THE PARK

ARUN, a college student, walks slowly through a park while looking at his phone. He sits alone on a bench and scrolls through social media.

He sees photos of his friends enjoying themselves. He smiles for a moment, but the smile slowly disappears.

He locks his phone and looks around the park.

After a few seconds, he checks the time.

ARUN

I should be doing something better.

He puts the phone away but takes it out again almost immediately. He continues scrolling.

0:30–1:00 — GOING HOME

Arun walks back home. As he walks, he receives a notification on his phone.

MESSAGE: "Did you finish it?"

Arun looks at the message. He types: "I'll do it later." He sends it.

He puts the phone in his pocket and continues walking. After a few steps, he stops and looks at his phone again. He opens another app and starts scrolling.

1:00–1:30 — THE MIRROR

Arun enters his house and drops his bag on the bed. He looks tired.

He walks toward the mirror and looks at himself. He adjusts his hair and smiles. Then his expression becomes serious.

ARUN

What am I doing?

He looks at himself for a few seconds. He raises his right hand. The reflection raises its hand. He lowers his hand. Everything seems normal. Arun turns away.

1:30–2:00 — SOMETHING IS WRONG

Arun turns back toward the mirror. He sees his reflection smiling. But Arun isn't smiling.
He freezes. He slowly moves closer to the mirror.

ARUN

Stop.

The reflection becomes serious. Arun takes a step backward.

ARUN

I'm just tired.

A few seconds of silence. Then a voice comes from the reflection.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

Are you?

Arun looks shocked.

ARUN

Who said that?

The reflection stares directly at him. CUT TO BLACK.

--- CAT-2 ENDS HERE ---

FADE IN:

2:00–2:40 — THE CONVERSATION

Arun stands in front of the mirror again. He looks nervous but tries to remain calm.

ARUN

You're not real.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

Then why are you afraid?

Arun doesn't answer.

ARUN

I'm not afraid.

The reflection smiles slightly.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

You always say that.

Arun looks away.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

"I'm fine."

REFLECTION (V.O.)

"I'll do it later."

REFLECTION (V.O.)

"I don't care."

ARUN

Enough.

2:40–3:20 — THE TRUTH

Arun sits on the floor in front of the mirror. The reflection continues watching him.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

You keep saying tomorrow.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

Tomorrow you'll study.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

Tomorrow you'll start.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

Tomorrow you'll change.

Arun looks down.

ARUN

I was going to.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

When?

Arun doesn't answer.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

You aren't waiting for the right time.

A pause.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

You're waiting because you're scared.

Arun looks at the mirror.

3:20–4:00 — THE REALIZATION

Arun picks up his notebook from the floor. He opens it. Inside are several unfinished plans and crossed-out goals. He looks at them one by one.

ARUN

I tried.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

You started.

A pause.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

Then you stopped.

Arun closes the notebook.

ARUN

What if I fail?

REFLECTION (V.O.)

Then fail.

Arun looks confused.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

But don't fail without trying.

Arun remains silent.

4:00–4:35 — THE DECISION

Arun stands up and faces the mirror.

ARUN

So what should I do?

The reflection becomes calm.

REFLECTION (V.O.)

Start.

ARUN

What if I'm still scared?

REFLECTION (V.O.)

Start scared.

Arun takes a deep breath. He looks at himself.

ARUN

Okay.

For the first time, the reflection and Arun smile at the same time.

4:35–5:00 — THE CHANGE

The next morning. Arun walks through the same park from the beginning.

This time, he doesn't take out his phone. He sits on the same bench and opens his notebook. He starts writing.

After a few seconds, he stops and looks around. He smiles.

He takes out his phone. For a moment, he looks at it. Then he switches it off and puts it back into his pocket.

Arun continues writing. The camera slowly moves away.

TEXT ON SCREEN:

"Sometimes the biggest person stopping you is yourself."

"Face yourself. Start anyway."

END

DIRECTOR'S NOTE

The film is about a student who constantly postpones his responsibilities because of fear, distraction and self-doubt.

The mirror represents Arun's inner voice. The reflection says the things Arun already knows but refuses to accept.

The first two minutes create a mystery when Arun discovers that his reflection can speak. This gives the CAT-2 section a clear hook.

The final three minutes reveal that the reflection is not a real supernatural character. It represents Arun's own thoughts and conscience.

The conflict is Man vs. Himself.

The film can be shot completely with one actor. The reflection's voice can be recorded separately and added during editing. The park scenes can be filmed in the morning or evening, while the mirror scenes can be filmed at home.

MAIN MESSAGE

Don't wait until you stop being afraid. Start even when you are afraid.